

B2

GRAMMAR LESSON · PAST TENSES

Past Perfect Continuous

had been doing — a long action up to a point in the past.

Geçmişte Süregelen Eylem

QUICK UNDERSTANDING

Past Perfect Continuous, geçmişte belirli bir **noktaya kadar bir süre boyunca devam etmiş** bir eylemi anlatır; genellikle o eylemin sonucunu ya da nedenini vurgular. Türkçedeki "-mekte olmuştu / -iyordu (bir süredir)" ifadesine yakındır: "Üç saattir bekliyordum (sonra o geldi)" gibi.

The Structure

Formula

Subject + had been + fiil-ing

had been, tüm öznelerle aynı kalır; fiile -ing eklenir. Genellikle for/since ile süre belirtilir.

Affirmative / Negative / Question

AFFIRMATIVE

Subject + had been + V-ing
We had been driving for hours.

NEGATIVE

Subject + hadn't been + V-ing
She hadn't been sleeping well.

QUESTION

Had + subject + been + V-ing?
Had you been waiting long?

Word Order

Özne — had been — fiil-ing — (for/since + süre) — (when/before + Past Simple referans olay).

- I **had been working** there **for** five years **when** the company closed. — Şirket kapandığında orada beş yıldır çalışıyordum.
- She **had been feeling** unwell **since** Monday. — Pazartesi'den beri kendini iyi hissetmiyordu.

How It Works

When do we use it?

- **Geçmişteki bir noktaya kadar SÜRE vurgusu için:** She had been studying for three hours before she took a break.
- **Bir sonucun sebebini açıklamak için:** His eyes were red because he had been crying.
- **since/for ile eylemin ne kadar/ne zamandan beri sürdüğünü belirtmek için:** They had been living in Bursa for six years before they moved.
- **Past Perfect'ten farklı olarak eylemin SÜRESİNİ vurgulamak için:** He had been writing the novel for two years (süreç vurgusu) vs He had written the novel (tamamlanma vurgusu).

When DON'T we use it?

Tek seferlik, süresi olmayan bir olay için had been + -ing KULLANMA — süre/devamlılık vurgusu yoksa Past Perfect (had + V3) yeterlidir.

✗ He had been arriving late when the meeting started. → ✓ He had arrived late when the meeting started.

state (durum) fiillerini had been ile -ing yaparak KULLANMA: ✗ I had been knowing her for years. → ✓ I had known her for years.

Short Answers

Yes, I had. / No, I hadn't.

Not: "been" ve "-ing" kısa cevaplarda tekrar edilmez, sadece had/hadn't kalır.

Türkçe Mantığı

Zihninde şu sırayla ilerle:

TÜRKÇEDE NE DEMEK İSTİYORUM? → "O geldiğinde iki saattir bekliyordum." → BİR SÜRE Mİ DEVAM ETTİ, GEÇMİŞ BİR NOKTAYA KADAR MI? → Evet, iki saat boyunca — bir referans noktasına (onun gelişine) kadar → HANGİ ZAMAN? → Past Perfect Continuous (had been + -ing) → CÜMLE → "I had been waiting for two hours when he arrived."

Examples

TEMEL (SÜRE VURGUSU)

- I had been studying for two hours when my friend called. — Arkadaşım aradığında iki saattir ders çalışıyordum.
- They had been waiting at the bus stop for twenty minutes. — Otobüs durağında yirmi dakikadır bekliyorlardı.
- She hadn't been sleeping well before the exam. — Sınavdan önce iyi uyuyamıyordu.

SEBEP-SONUÇ

- His shirt was wet because he had been running in the rain. — Gömleği ıslaktı çünkü yağmurda koşuyordu.
- Her eyes were red because she had been crying all night. — Gözleri kızarmıştı çünkü bütün gece ağlıyordu.
- Mert was exhausted because he had been working overtime all week. — Mert bitkindi çünkü bütün hafta fazla mesai yapıyordu.

SINCE/FOR VE PAST PERFECT İLE KARŞILAŞTIRMA

- They had been living in that house for ten years before they sold it. — O evi satmadan önce orada on yıldır yaşıyorlardı.
- Had you been waiting long when the bus finally came? — Otobüs sonunda geldiğinde uzun süredir mi bekliyordun?
- He had been learning Spanish for a year before he moved to Madrid. — Madrid'e taşınmadan önce bir yıldır İspanyolca öğreniyordu.
- We had been discussing the plan for hours, but we still hadn't decided. — Planı saatlerdir tartışıyorduk ama hâlâ karar verememiştik.
- He had finished the report by Friday, after he had been writing it for two weeks. — İki haftadır yazdıktan sonra raporu Cuma gününe kadar bitirmişti.

Compare & Notice

Compare With

Past Perfect Continuous	Past Perfect
Süreç/devamlılık vurgusu — eylem ne kadar sürdü? He had been writing for two hours.	Tamamlanma vurgusu — eylem bitti mi, sonucu ne? He had written three pages.

→ Past Perfect konusuna git

Visual Timeline

Timeline: had been + -ing (süreç başladı ve devam etti) · Past Simple (referans nokta, örneğin "when he arrived")

Common Mistakes

✗ He had been arriving late when the meeting started.	✓ He had arrived late when the meeting started.
WHY? "arrive" ani, tek seferlik bir eylemdir; süre/devamlılık vurgusu yoksa Past Perfect (had + V3) yeterlidir, had been + -ing gereksizdir.	
✗ I had been knowing her for years.	✓ I had known her for years.
WHY? "know" gibi durum (state) fiilleri -ing alamaz; süre vurgusu için bile Past Perfect (had + V3) kullanılır.	
✗ They had be waiting for an hour.	✓ They had been waiting for an hour.
WHY? Yapı "had been + V-ing"dir; "be" fiili "been" olarak V3 halinde kullanılmalıdır, yalın "be" değil.	
✗ His shirt was wet because he had run in the rain for an hour.	✓ His shirt was wet because he had been running in the rain for an hour.
WHY? Süreç/devamlılık ve sebep-sonuç ilişkisi vurgulanmak istendiğinde had been + -ing tercih edilir; sadece had + V3 kullanmak süreç vurgusunu kaybettirir.	

Practice

Name: _____

Date: _____

Score: _____ / 21

PART A · QUICK CHECK

1. She _____ for three hours before she took a break.

- a) has been studying b) was study c) had been studying d) had studying

2. Find the mistake and correct it.

They had ^A be ^B waiting for an hour. ^C

Correction: _____

3. His eyes were red because he _____ .

- a) has been crying b) had cry c) cried tomorrow d) had been crying

PART B · PRACTICE

4. They _____ (live) in Bursa for six years before they moved.

5. Find the mistake and correct it.

I ^A had been knowing ^B her for years. ^C

Correction: _____

6. The ground was wet. It _____ .

- a) had been raining b) rains c) has been raining d) had rain

7. Find the mistake and correct it.

He ^A had been arriving ^B late when the meeting started. ^C

Correction: _____

8. You explain why you were so tired at the party.

Which sentence is correct?

- a) I have been working for twelve hours.
b) I had been working for twelve hours.
c) I had working for twelve hours.
d) I was been working for twelve hours.

9. "When I arrived, she had been waiting for an hour." What does it mean?

- a) She started waiting an hour before I arrived.
b) She will wait for an hour.
c) She started waiting when I arrived.
d) She didn't wait.

10. How long _____ you been working there before you left?

- a) had b) were c) did d) have

11. By the time the taxi came, we _____ (wait) for 40 minutes.

PART C · FINAL CHECK

12. Her shirt was wet because she _____ in the rain.

- a) runs
- b) had run in the rain for
- c) has been running
- d) had been running

13. He _____ three chapters by midnight.

- a) had written
- b) has written
- c) writes
- d) had been writing three

14. I _____ (drive) for hours, so I needed a break.

15. Find the mistake and correct it.

His shirt was wet because he ^A had run ^B in the rain for an hour. ^C

Correction: _____

16. They were out of breath. They _____ .

- a) have run
- b) had been running
- c) were run
- d) had been run

17. Your friend describes finding her brother asleep at his desk.

Which sentence fits?

- a) He had been studying all night.
- b) He has been studying all night.
- c) He had studying all night.
- d) He studied all night tomorrow.

18. "The children were dirty because they had been playing in the mud." What does it explain?

- a) the reason for the dirt
- b) something happening now
- c) a future plan
- d) a habit

19. She _____ in Paris for ten years when she met him.

- a) had been living
- b) lives
- c) has been living
- d) is living

20. Which sentence is correct?

- a) We have been walking for hours when we found the village.
- b) We had been walking for hours when we found the village.
- c) We had walking for hours when we found the village.
- d) We were been walking for hours when we found the village.

21. Join: "I waited for 20 minutes. Then the bus came."

I had been waiting for 20 minutes _____ .

Answer Key

Kısa açıklamalar, her cevabın hangi kurala dayandığını gösterir.

PART A · QUICK CHECK

1. **c) had been studying** — Geçmişteki bir ana kadar süre → had been + V-ing.
2. **B — be → been** — had + been + V-ing.
3. **d) had been crying** — Geçmiş bir sonucun sebebi → had been crying.

PART B · PRACTICE

4. **had been living / had lived** — Süre vurgusu; live ile simple da mümkündür.
5. **B — had been knowing → had known** — know → simple.
6. **a) had been raining** — Geçmişteki sonuç + sebep → had been raining.
7. **B — had been arriving → had arrived** — Tek seferlik, kısa eylem → past perfect simple.
8. **b) I had been working for twelve hours.** — Geçmişteki ana kadar süre → had been working.
9. **a) She started waiting an hour before I arrived.** — had been + V-ing → varışından önce 1 saattir bekliyordu.
10. **a) had** — Geçmişteki ana kadar süre sorusu → How long had you been...?
11. **had been waiting** — by the time + süre.

PART C · FINAL CHECK

12. **d) had been running** — Süre + sonuç → had been running.
13. **a) had written** — Sayı/sonuç → past perfect simple.
14. **had been driving** — Süre → had been driving.
15. **B — had run → had been running** — for an hour + süreç → continuous.
16. **b) had been running** — Geçmiş sonucun sebebi → had been running.
17. **a) He had been studying all night.** — Geçmiş sonuç (uyumuş) + süreç → had been studying.
18. **a) the reason for the dirt** — Sebep → past perfect continuous.
19. **a) had been living** — Geçmişteki bir ana kadar süre.
20. **b) We had been walking for hours when we found the village.** — had been + V-ing.
21. **I had been waiting for 20 minutes when the bus came .** — had been + V-ing + when/before.

Bu dersin interaktif versiyonu (anında geri bildirimli alıştırma):

<https://abonlinenglish.school/grammar/b2/past-perfect-continuous>